
AI-102 Natural Language Processing (NLP)

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EMERGING &
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Understanding Text Data

Nature of Text Data

Text data, found in forms such as articles, social media posts, emails, chat messages, and reviews, is inherently **unstructured**. Unlike numerical data, it lacks an immediate, easy-to-analyze format for machines. The inherent complexity of human language is a primary challenge, encompassing:



Text files and documents



Server, website and application logs



Sensor data



Images



Video files



Audio files



Emails



Social media data

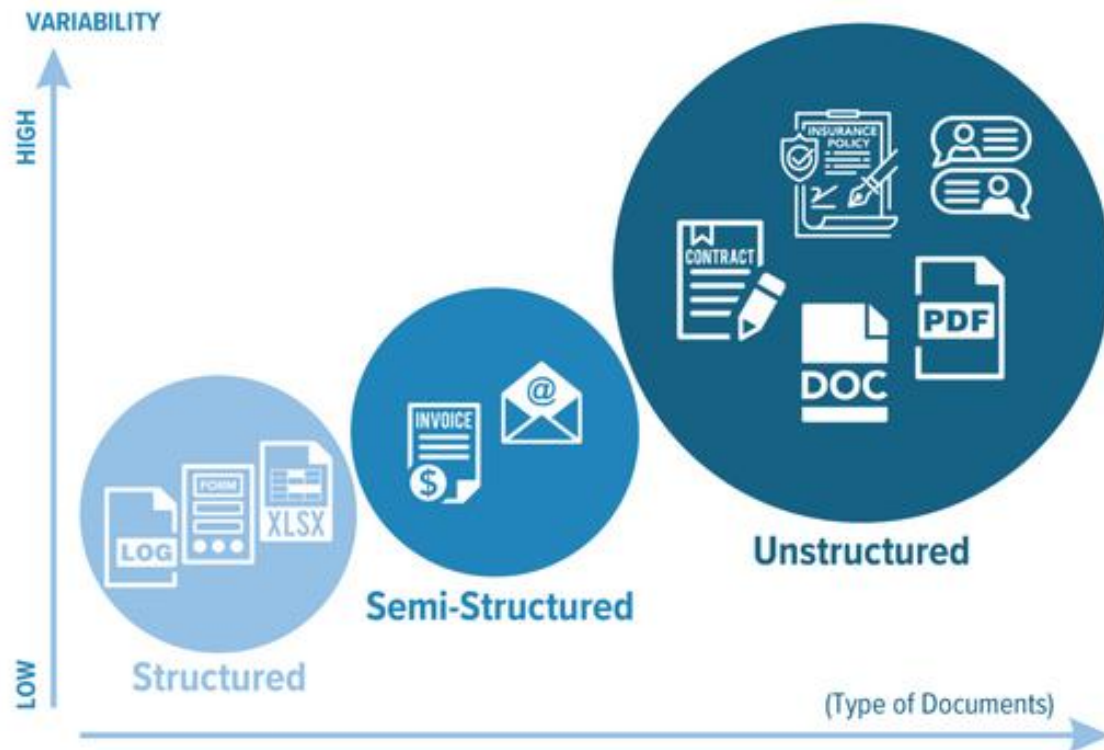
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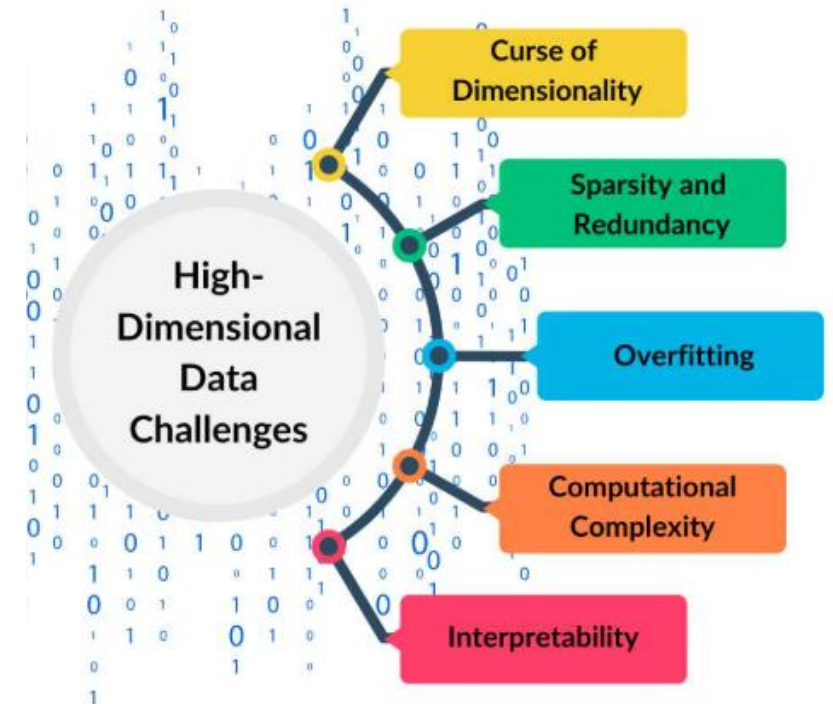
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High Dimensionality: A large vocabulary creates a massive number of features, increasing

- **computational complexity**: Increased resources needed for processing and analysis.
- **risk of overfitting**: Machine learning models may fit noise rather than underlying patterns.
- **curse of dimensionality**: data becomes too sparse to find meaningful patterns.



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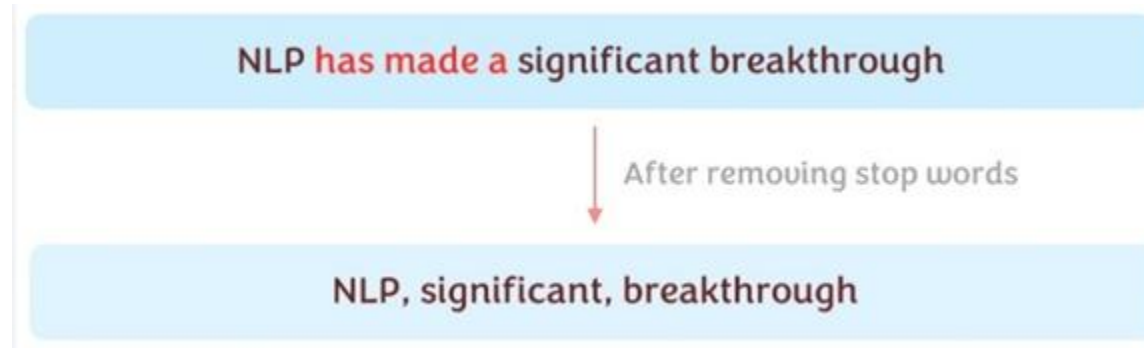
Feature Extraction: This is an essential part of preprocessing that involves techniques such as tokenization, vectorization, and embedding representations. These features are then used by machine learning models to learn patterns and make predictions or classifications.

Noise Reduction



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3. **Non-essential Elements:** This includes removing numbers, special characters, HTML tags, or any other elements that do not add value to the understanding of the text.

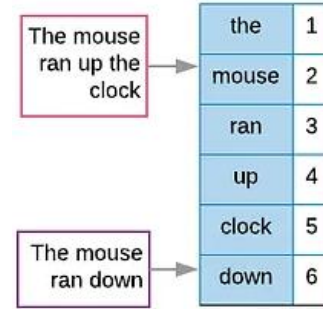
Standardization

Stemming	Lemmatization
adjustable → adjust	was → (to) be
formality → formalit	better → good
formaliti → formal	meeting → meeting
airliner → airlin	

1. **Lowercasing:** This step involves converting all the letters in a text to lowercase. The main purpose of lowercasing is to ensure that words like 'Apple' and 'apple' are not treated as different entities by the system, thus avoiding any discrepancies caused by capitalization.
2. **Stemming:** Stemming is the process of reducing words to their base or root form. For example, the word 'running' can be reduced to the root form 'run'. This helps in treating different morphological variants of a word as a single term.
3. **Lemmatization:** "Lemmatization is a process similar to stemming, but it is more sophisticated and context-aware. It reduces words to their dictionary or canonical form. For instance, "better" is lemmatized to "good."

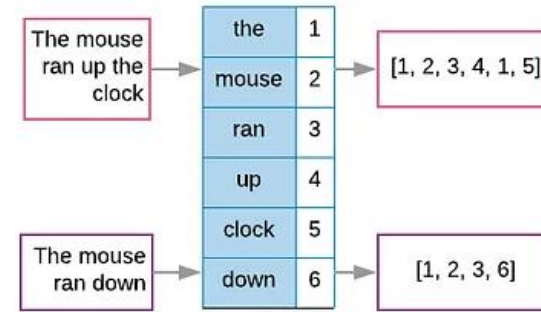
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1. **Tokenization:** This is an essential process involving breaking down the text into individual units called tokens, which can be as small as words or as large as phrases. It organizes text into manageable and structured pieces.



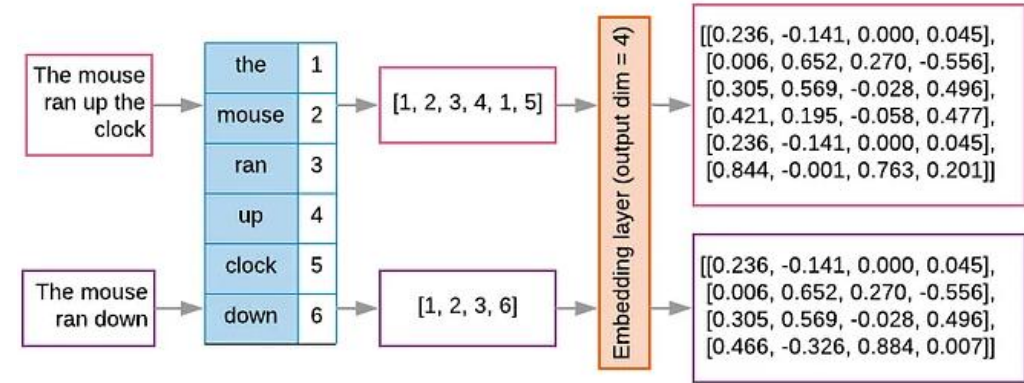
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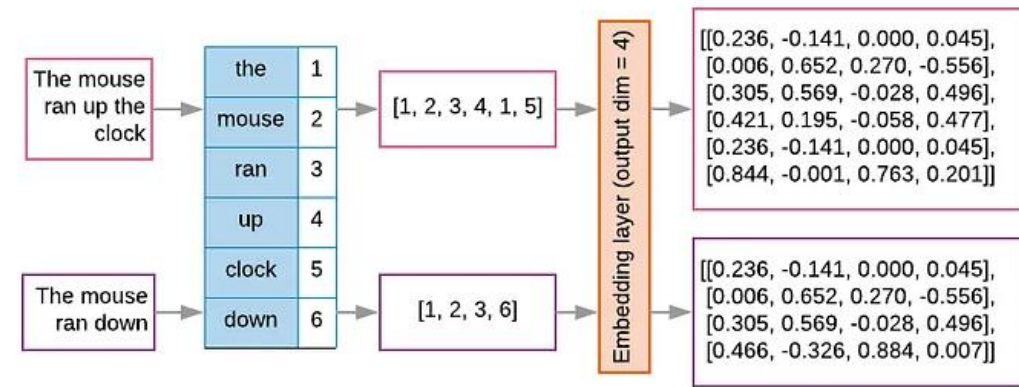
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Parameters	Tokenization	Embedding
Definition	Converts large text into separate words, subwords, or characters (tokens).	Maps tokens into dense, continuous vector representations.
Use	Pre-processing text into manageable units.	Capturing semantic meaning so models can analyze and interpret.
Output	Sequence of tokens with index values.	Sequence of fixed-size vector representations.
Example	"Machine Learning" → ["Machine", "Learning"]	["Machine", "Learning"] → [embedding ₁ , embedding ₂]
Granularity	Character-level → very fine; word-level → coarser; sub-word → intermediate.	Higher granularity → more detailed vectors; lower → more abstract.
Tool Stack	Tokenizers: Byte Pair Encoding, SentencePiece, WordPiece.	Embeddings: GloVe, BERT, Word2Vec, DeBERTa.
Common Libraries	spaCy, nltk, transformers	torch.nn.Embedding, gensim, transformers

Regular Expression (Regex)

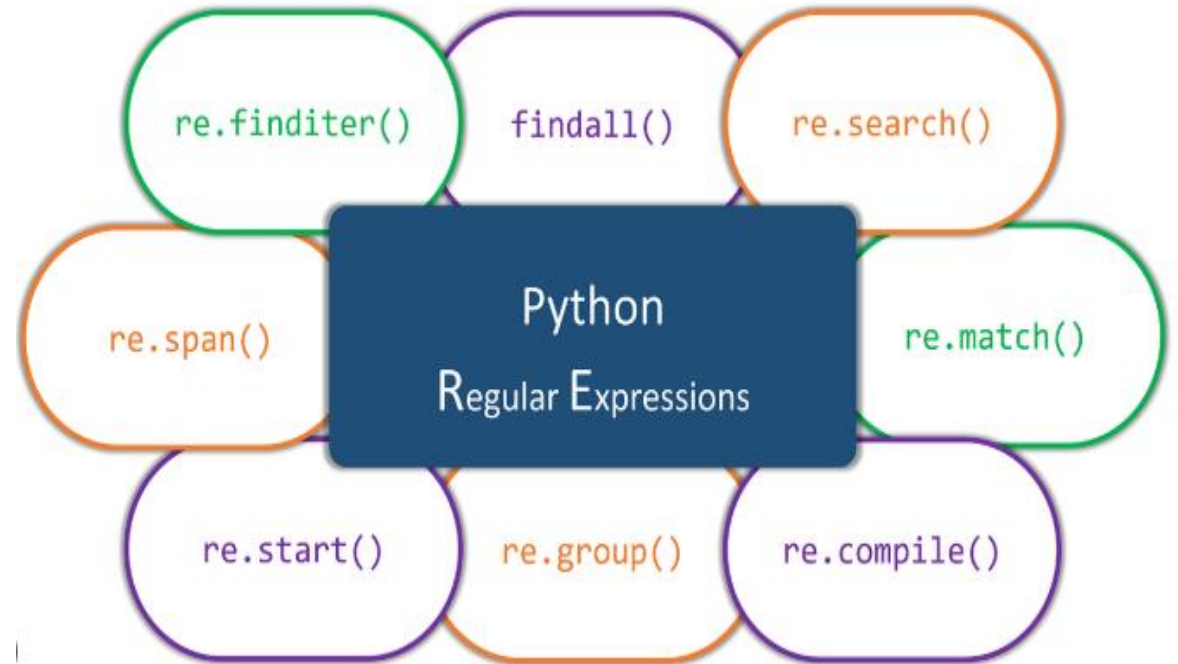
- A sequence of characters that defines a search pattern.
- A concise and flexible tool for finding, replacing, and manipulating text.
- Used to match patterns within strings, rather than fixed text.
- Often used in programming languages, text editors, and search engines for tasks like data validation, parsing, and web scraping.



The re Module in Python

Python integrates regular expressions through its built-in re module. This module provides various functions for searching, matching, and manipulating strings based on predefined patterns. Key functions include:

- **re.search():** Used to find the first occurrence of a pattern in a string.
- **re.match():** Checks for a match only at the beginning of the string (not explicitly detailed in provided excerpts but generally part of the module).
- **re.findall():** Returns all non-overlapping matches of a pattern in a string as a list of strings.
- **re.sub():** Replaces occurrences of a pattern in a string with a specified replacement



Basic Components of Regex

Regular Expression Basics

.	Any character except newline
a	The character a
ab	The string ab
a b	a or b
a*	0 or more a's
\	Escapes a special character

Regular Expression Quantifiers

*	0 or more
+	1 or more
?	0 or 1
{2}	Exactly 2
{2, 5}	Between 2 and 5
{2,}	2 or more
{,5}	Up to 5

Default is greedy. Append ? for reluctant.

Regular Expression Groups

(...)	Capturing group
(?P<Y>...)	Capturing group named Y
(?:...)	Non-capturing group
\Y	Match the Y'th captured group
(?P=Y)	Match the named group Y
(?#...)	Comment

Regular Expression Character Classes

[ab-d]	One character of: a, b, c, d
[^ab-d]	One character except: a, b, c, d
[\b]	Backspace character
\d	One digit
\D	One non-digit
\s	One whitespace
\S	One non-whitespace
\w	One word character
\W	One non-word character

Regular Expression Assertions

^	Start of string
\A	Start of string, ignores m flag
\$	End of string
\Z	End of string, ignores m flag
\b	Word boundary
\B	Non-word boundary
(?=...)	Positive lookahead
(?!...)	Negative lookahead
(?<=...)	Positive lookbehind
(?<!...)	Negative lookbehind
(?())	Conditional

Regular Expression Flags

i	Ignore case
m	^ and \$ match start and end of line
s	. matches newline as well
x	Allow spaces and comments
L	Locale character classes
u	Unicode character classes
(?iLmsux)	Set flags within regex

Regular Expression Special Characters

\n	Newline
\r	Carriage return
\t	Tab
\YYY	Octal character YYY
\xYY	Hexadecimal character YY

Regular Expression Replacement

\g<0>	Insert entire match
\g<Y>	Insert match Y (name or number)
\Y	Insert group numbered Y



Practical Application of Regex

Regular expressions are incredibly versatile and can be used for a wide range of tasks, from simple search and replace operations to complex text extraction and validation.

- **Text Search:** Finding and locating specific words, phrases, or patterns within a larger body of text.
- **Data Validation:** Verifying that a string conforms to a specific format, such as an email address or a phone number.
- **Text Processing & Extraction:** Removing or extracting specific parts of a string based on a pattern, often for data cleaning (e.g., removing HTML tags, extracting hashtags).
- **Data Transformation:** Modifying the structure or format of text data, like standardizing phone numbers or converting all text to lowercase.

Basic pattern matching using *search()*

```
import re

pattern = "Python"
text = "I write code in Python."
match = re.search(pattern, text)
print("Match found:", bool(match))
```

Using *findall()* to find all occurrences of a pattern

```
import re

pattern = "a"
text = "I love to code in Python and it's amazing!"
matches = re.findall(pattern, text)
print("Matches found:", len(matches))
```

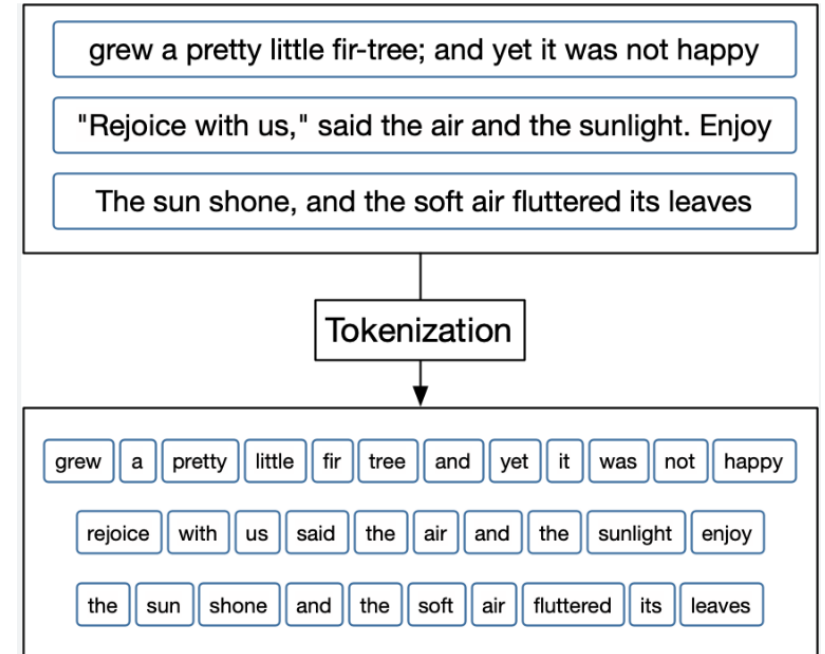
Using *sub()* to replace a pattern with a string

```
import re

pattern = "Python"
replacement = "Java"
text = "Python is fun"
substituted_text = re.sub(pattern, replacement, text)
print("Substituted text:", substituted_text)
```

Important Tokenization

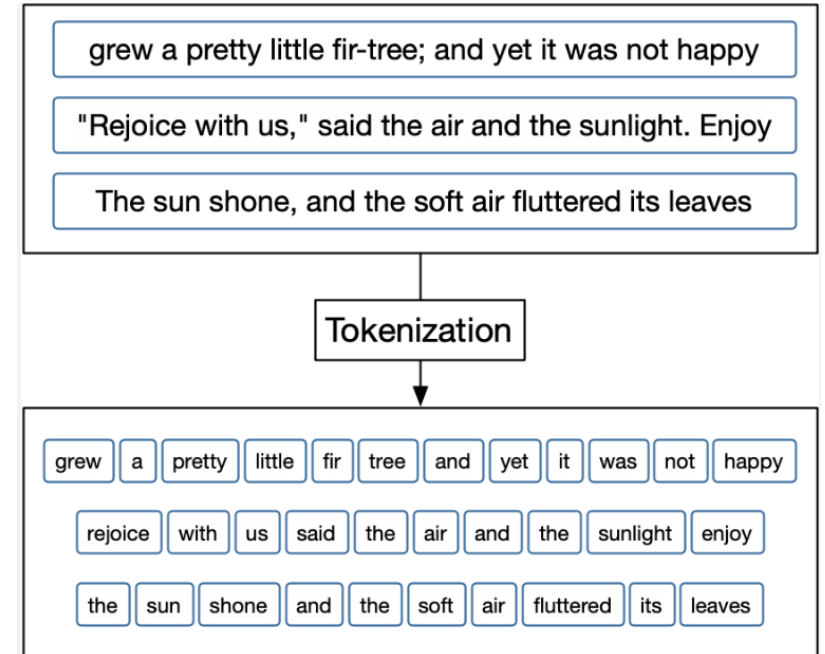
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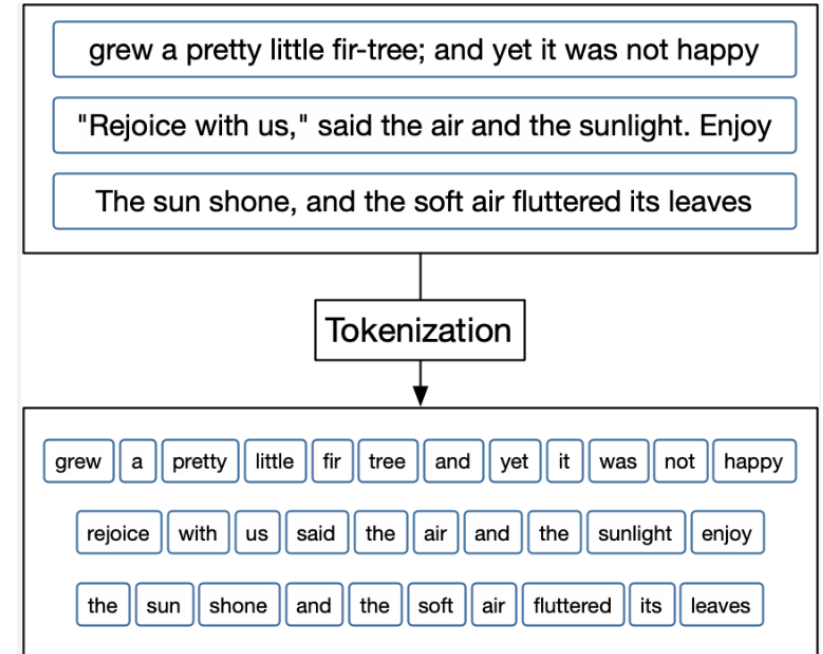


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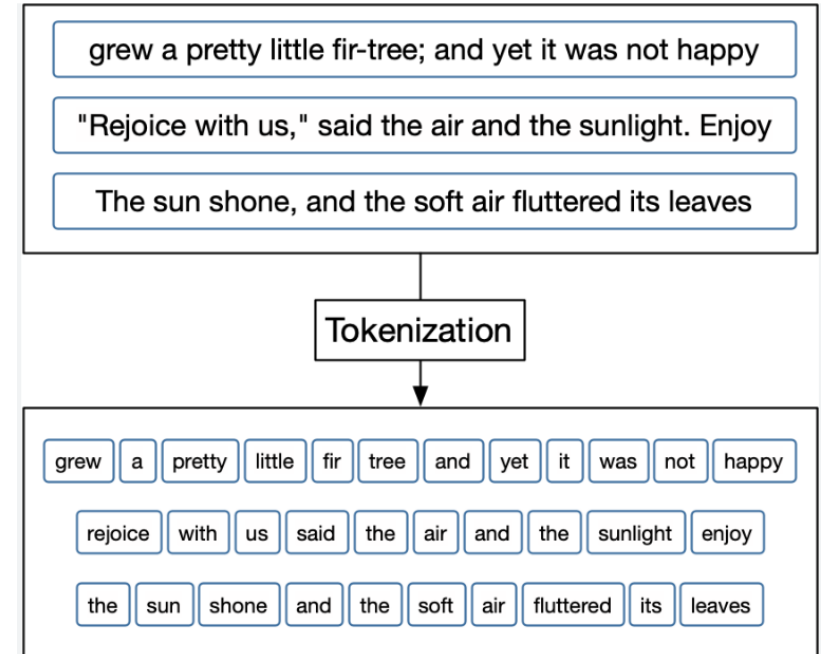
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Feature Extraction: It facilitates the extraction of meaningful features from the text. By breaking text into tokens, it becomes possible to identify and utilize these features as inputs in various machine learning models, enabling tasks like sentiment analysis, and execute various other natural language processing tasks



Type of Tokenization

Word Tokenization: The most common type of tokenization, it splits text into individual words. This is foundational for tasks like text classification, sentiment analysis, and named entity recognition. Libraries like NLTK and spaCy offer robust functions for this.

Input Text

Tokenization is one of the first step in any NLP pipeline. Tokenization is nothing but splitting the raw text into small chunks of words or sentences, called tokens.

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**Sentence
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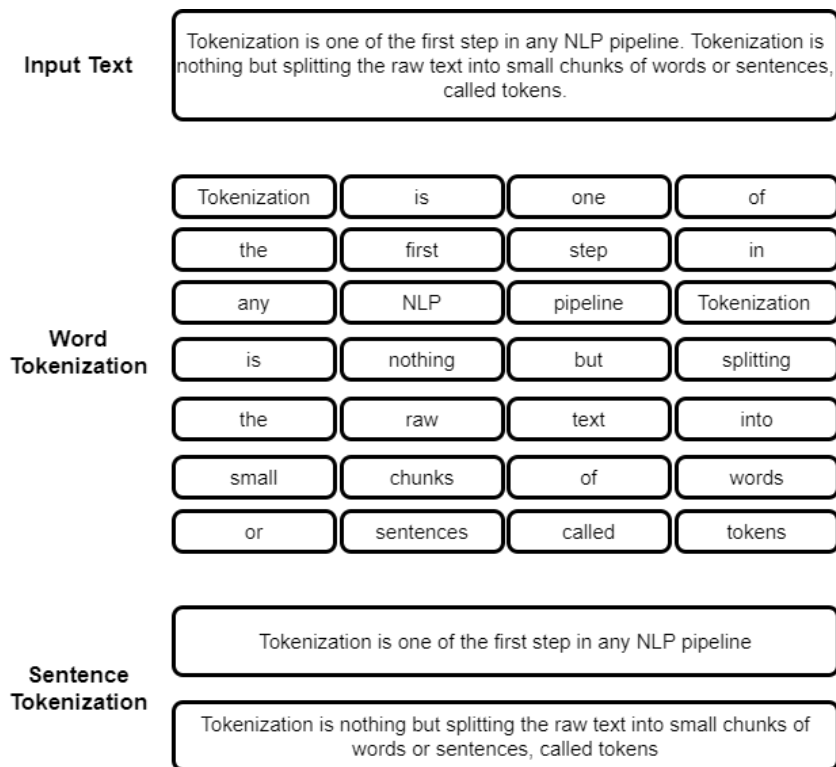
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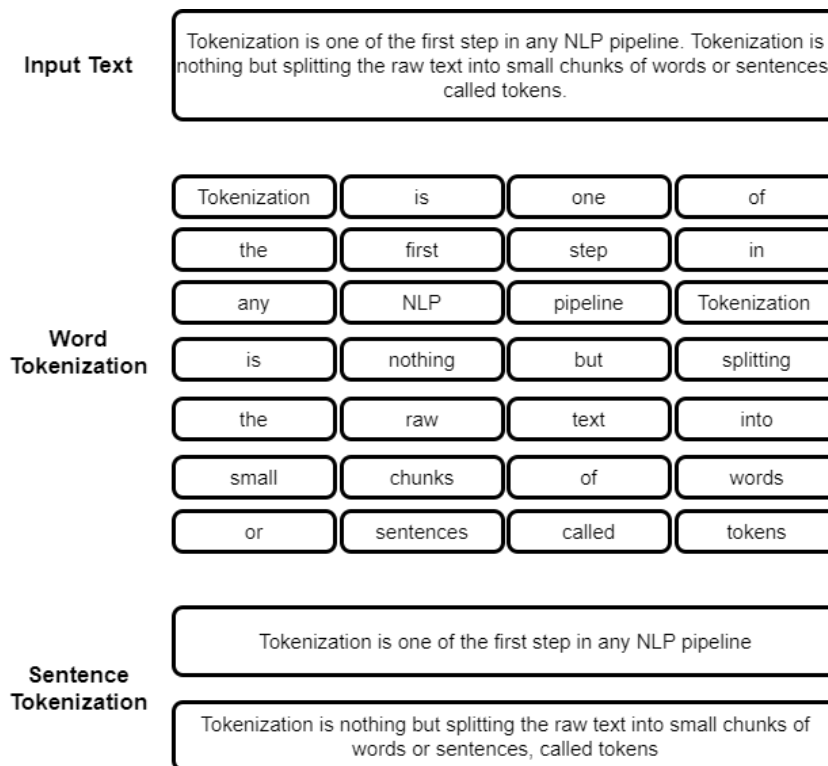


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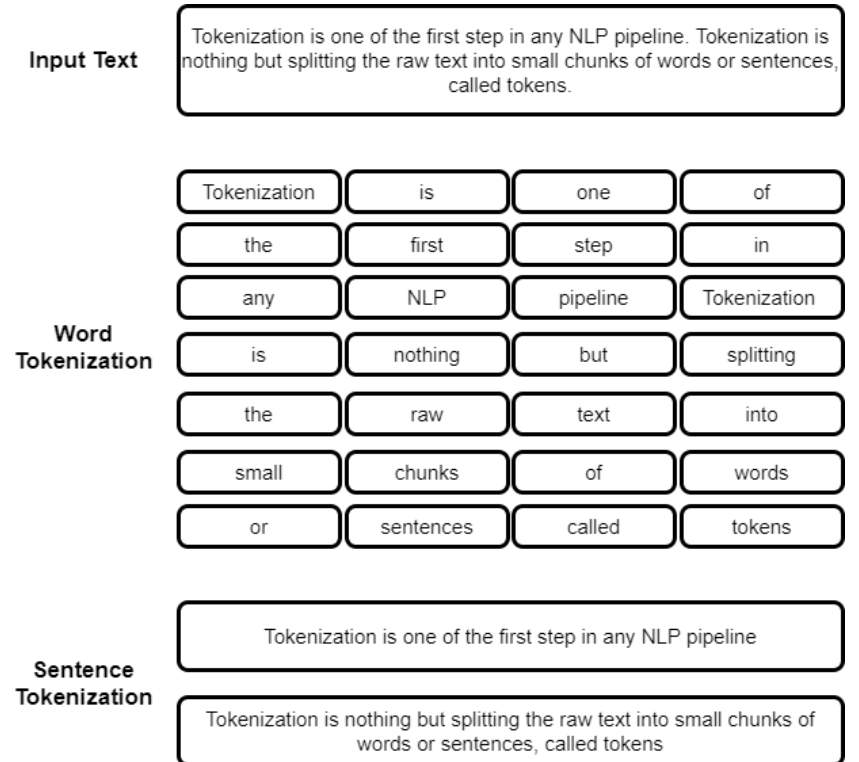
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Alphanumeric Word Tokenization: A specific word tokenization technique that typically involves removing punctuation and other non-alphanumeric characters to convert unstructured text into a structured, cleaner format for algorithms.



Tokenization using Python Libraries

Word Tokenization

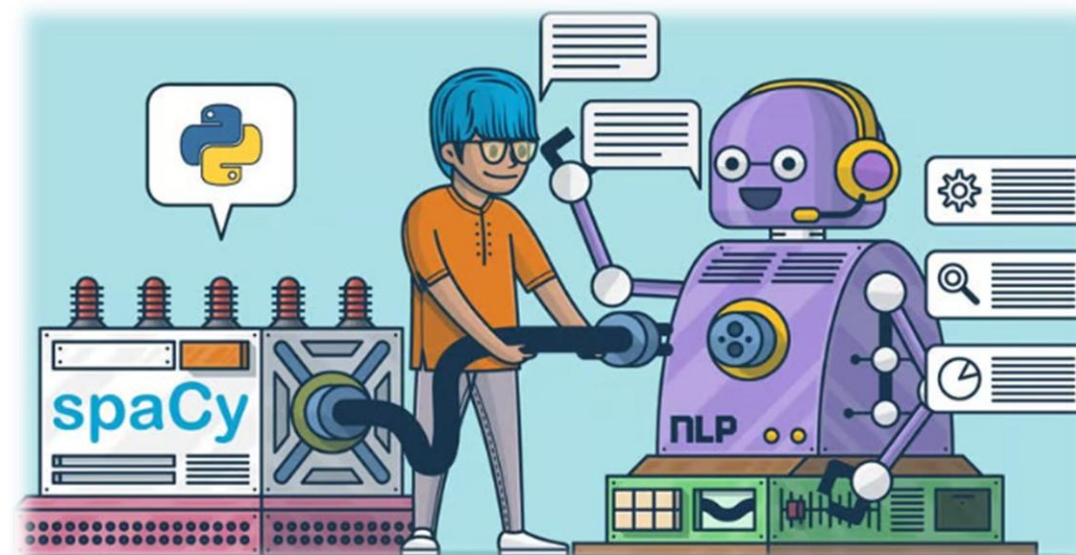
- **NLTK:** Uses the `word_tokenize` function to split text into words. You need to download the `punkt` model first.
 - **Example:** `nltk.word_tokenize("Hello world.")` → `['Hello', 'world', '.']`
- **SpaCy:** Processes text into a `Doc` object and then extracts tokens. It's often preferred for production due to its speed and efficiency.
 - **Example:** `doc = nlp("Hello world.")` → `[token.text for token in doc]` → `['Hello', 'world', '.']`

Sentence Tokenization

- **NLTK:** Employs the `sent_tokenize` function to split a document into sentences. It's a useful heuristic for structured text.
 - **Example:** `nltk.sent_tokenize("Hello world. This is a test.")` → `['Hello world.', 'This is a test.']`
- **SpaCy:** After creating a `Doc` object, you can access sentences via `doc.sents`.
 - **Example:** `doc = nlp("Hello world. This is a test.")` → `[sent.text for sent in doc.sents]` → `['Hello world.', 'This is a test.']`

Character Tokenization

- This is the simplest form, where a string is converted into a list of its individual characters.
 - **Example:** `list("Hello")` → `['H', 'e', 'l', 'l', 'o']`





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